

CONSUMER ELECTRONICS TRENDS TO WATCH OUT FOR

A peek into key trends being witnessed by the consumer electronics industry across the globe

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Interactions with industry leaders at the pre-show conference of *IFA Berlin 2009* provided an interesting insight into key trends being witnessed by the consumer electronics industry. Though the trends discussed were global, some have started happening in India too, and the rest are most likely to arrive soon.

New TV screens

Energy efficiency, further improvements in picture quality, especially on

LCD televisions, and slimmer units are some of the key improvements that one can look out for in the world of televisions.

LED backlighting for LCD screens is the 'in thing' now, resulting in lower power consumption, making the screens thinner and thinner. One can start seeing its effects in India, too (see story 'Thin is in' on page 78).

Plus, new models are going to operate at a many times higher frequency than the standard picture frequency and include cleverly calculated intermediate images. These

LED-powered LCDs

These LCD screens have individual LED light cells that can be controlled to match the brightness specifications of the picture content and this enables much higher contrast levels to be achieved while also conserving energy.

improvements will, in turn, result in clear and detailed pictures when the camera pans across an entire football pitch in a fraction of a second—something that's still an unresolved issue with the existing screens.

Internet on TV

The top-of-the-range models of television sets are gearing up to bring the Internet into the home. Video-clips from YouTube webpages, slide shows from the online photo service Picasa, weather reports, breaking news, sporting events and stock market prices are all now available at the click of a button.

Television manufacturers are using a number of different technologies, such as standardised browsers or special widgets, but in every case the



Panasonic VIERA PZ850 series HDTV featuring VIERA CAST technology lets you enjoy amazing Web entertainment on a large screen